Baseline observation kit

How the Registrar's and Cashier's offices work today, measured on paper before the system exists · BISU Registrar, Balilihan Campus · Version 1, 18 October 2026

Why we measure the "before"

- The thesis claims the system makes service **faster and clearer**. A claim needs a "before" number to compare with.
- Real waiting times, peak hours and turnaround days let us set **honest targets** for the queue, reports and server size instead of guessing.
- It is cheap now and **impossible later**, because once the system runs the old way is gone.

What it takes

- **5 working days** in each office, including one day the office calls busy.
- **Two timed hours a day** (morning and afternoon) at the public counters, plus a tally of arrivals.
- **Counts and dates** copied from the office's own records, by or with a staff member.
- 2 observers per office are comfortable; 1 is enough on a quiet day.

Privacy rules. These come before anything else.

- **No names. No ID numbers. No receipt numbers. No photos, video or audio.** Not even "just for a moment".
- Each client is a **row number** and a **transaction code**. Nothing on the sheets can identify a person.
- The office head signs the permission form (page 2) **before** anyone observes. Inform the Data Protection Officer and the adviser as well.
- Do **not** interview or ask clients anything. Stand where staff tell you. Never look at staff screens or papers.
- If anyone, staff or client, asks you to stop, stop and tell the project lead.

What we measure and what each number is used for later

Measure	How we get it	Used for
Clients per day and per hour, and the peak hour	Tally of arrivals (Sheet A); the office's own daily counts (Sheet C)	Queue and counter design (Part 07); server size and load targets (D13)
Waiting time	Timed sample: arrival to start of service (Sheet B)	Thesis before/after comparison; queue targets (Parts 07, 12, 13)
Service time per transaction type	Timed sample: start to end of service (Sheet B)	Counters needed; ticket-calling rules (Part 07)
Left before service, or sent elsewhere	Outcome column (Sheet B)	No-show and recall rules (D06)
Turnaround days per document type	Dates received and released, from the office's log (Sheet C)	Charter processing-time reports (Parts 05, 12)
Mix of transaction types and priority-lane use	Tally columns (Sheet A)	First-release services (D01); priority lanes (D06)
How the office queues clients today and what goes wrong	Day sheet (Sheet D)	The request workflow (Part 01)

We report the **median** and the **90th percentile** (the wait that 9 in 10 clients stay under), not only the average, because a few very long waits hide in an average. Five days in each office gives a **picture, not proof**. Say so in the thesis limitations, and agree the method with the adviser first.

Permission to observe

One form per office · keep the signed copy with the project lead

The BISU Registrar project team asks permission to **observe the public counter area** of the office below. This is to count arrivals and time how long service takes, so that the planned system is designed from real figures and compared fairly after it is introduced.

What the team will and will not do

- Count arrivals and write down clock times and a transaction code for each client observed.
- Copy **dates and document types only** from the office's own logbook, with a staff member present or by a staff member (Sheet C).
- **Not** record names, ID numbers, receipt numbers, or any photo, video or audio. **Not** speak to clients or interrupt service.

Office _____

Dates of observation, from _____ to _____

Hours and place observers may stand _____

Days or periods to avoid (for example exams, or a day with special activity) _____

Team members who will observe (names) _____

Staff member who will help with Sheet C (name and position) _____

Please confirm

☐ The team may observe the public counter area as described above.

☐ Office staff may give **counts and dates only** from existing records for Sheet C (the office may say no to this part).

☐ The Data Protection Officer has been told about the observation. Date: _____

☐ The thesis adviser has agreed the method. Date: _____

Approval

Name of the office head _____

Position _____ Date _____

Signature _____

Prepared by the BISU Registrar project team. This form is a permission request from students working on a thesis. It is not an official BISU form and does not change any office rule or policy.

How to observe

Read this once, and keep it with the sheets.

The three clock times write them to the minute (HH:MM) from your phone clock

Time	The moment to record
Arrived	The client joins the line or waiting area, or takes a number if the office uses one. If you first notice them already waiting, write the time you noticed and tick "late" in Notes.
Service start	The client reaches the counter or window and the staff member begins to attend to them.
Service end	The client steps away from the counter after the transaction is done.

Waiting time = start minus arrived. Service time = end minus start. We calculate them later; you only write the clock times.

Each day do these in order

1. **Before you start:** check the signed permission form is on file. Fill in the top of Sheet D (the day sheet).
2. **Agree the transaction codes** with the office. Ask staff for the **five most common transactions** and write them at the top of Sheet A (Type 1 to 5). Everything else is "Other". **Use the office's words, not ours.** Keep the same codes all week.
3. **Tally (Sheet A), whenever you are present:** for each person who arrives, make one mark in the right column and the right 30-minute row. One mark per person, not per document.
4. **Timed windows (Sheet B):** twice a day, one hour each: the first hour of the morning and of the afternoon, or the office's own **peak hour** if it names one. Follow **every client who arrives**, one row each. If more than 12 arrive in 30 minutes, follow every **second** arrival and tick that box on the sheet.
5. **Records (Sheet C):** with the office's permission, copy the dates and document types, as the form describes. Only once per office.
6. **At closing:** finish Sheet D, and check that every timed row has its times or an outcome.

Outcome codes and special cases

Outcome (Sheet B)

- **S** served: the transaction was done at the counter.
- **L** left before service: they arrived and left without reaching the counter. Leave the start and end blank.
- **R** referred: sent to another office or window. Note which one if you can hear it without asking.

Special cases

- Someone **comes back later** the same day: a **new row**.
- Someone **cuts in or is served out of turn**: record the real times, and write "priority" in Notes if staff say it is a priority lane.
- The counter **closes for a break**: note it in Sheet D; do not stop the clock for the client.
- You are **unsure** of a time: write your best estimate and put "?" in Notes.

After each day within one day, while you remember

1. Type every row into the matching CSV template (provided with this kit), with the same column names. Fix typing mistakes, but **never change a recorded time** to look tidier.
2. Add up Sheet A and compare the total with the office's own daily count, if it keeps one. Note any large difference.
3. Give the paper sheets to the project lead. They hold no personal data. Keep them until the thesis is accepted, or destroy them earlier if the office asks. The "after" measurements will repeat exactly this method.

Sheet A · Arrivals tally

One sheet per office per day · copy as needed

Date _____ Office _____ Observer _____ Sheet no. _____

One mark per person who arrives. Write the office's five most common transactions in the blanks, and count everything else under "Other".

30-minute block	Type 1	Type 2	Type 3	Type 4	Type 5	Other	Served in a priority lane	Total
__:__ – __:__								
__:__ – __:__								
__:__ – __:__								
__:__ – __:__								
__:__ – __:__								
__:__ – __:__								
__:__ – __:__								
__:__ – __:__								
__:__ – __:__								
__:__ – __:__								
__:__ – __:__								
__:__ – __:__								
__:__ – __:__								
__:__ – __:__								
__:__ – __:__								
__:__ – __:__								
__:__ – __:__								
Day total								

"Served in a priority lane": count only the clients that **staff** treat as priority (for example senior citizens, persons with disabilities). Never ask a client, and never judge by appearance. If the office has no priority lane, leave this column empty and say so in Sheet D.

Sheet B · Timed sample

One sheet per timed window · copy as needed

Date _____ Office _____ Window (clock times) _____ Observer _____

☐ Following **every** arrival ☐ Following every **2nd** arrival (more than 12 per 30 minutes)

One row per person. No names. Codes: **Type** = 1–5 or O from Sheet A. **Outcome** = S served, L left before service, R referred. Times as HH:MM.

Row	Type	Arrived	Service start	Service end	Outcome	Notes (priority, "late", "?", closed counter)
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						
8						
9						
10						
11						
12						
13						
14						
15						
16						
17						
18						
19						
20						

Sheet C · From the office's own records

Once per office · counts and dates only

Only copy dates, document types and counts. Never copy a name, ID number, receipt number, address or signature. A staff member should be present, or fill this in themselves. The office may decline this sheet.

Office _____ Records used (logbook, list, file name) Copied by _____ Date _____

C1 · Daily counts ask for the last full semester, or the last 3 months

Ask the office for **daily or weekly totals** if it already keeps them. A table or photocopy of the count columns only is fine. Write the period and the numbers below, or attach it.

Day or week (dates)	Clients served	Documents or transactions issued	Notes (event, suspension, enrollment, graduation)

C2 · Turnaround of documents that take more than a day the last 20 completed requests of each common type

One row per completed request. **Type** uses the office's own name for the document. If the office records the date the client claimed the document, write it too.

#	Document type	Date received	Date ready or released	Date claimed (if kept)	Notes
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					
10					

Copy this table for more rows. We count the **working days** between received and released ourselves, using the office calendar, and compare them with the Citizen's Charter processing time once we have it.

Sheet D · Day sheet

One per office per day

Date _____ Office _____ Observer(s) _____ Weather or event _____

The office today

Opens _____ Closes _____ Break or lunch closed _____

Counters open _____ Staff at counters _____ Staff in back office _____

How clients are lined up today **tick what you see**

- ☐ One line, first come first served
- ☐ Numbered tickets or slips
- ☐ By appointment or schedule
- ☐ A separate priority or express lane (describe what staff say it is for): _____
- ☐ No priority lane in this office
- ☐ Other: _____

What happened

Longest line seen _____ people at _____

Power, network or computer problem (what and from–to) _____

Counter closed unexpectedly (which and from–to) _____

Anything staff called a bottleneck or a repeated problem _____

Anything else worth knowing _____

Closing check

- ☐ No names, ID numbers or receipt numbers are written on any sheet.
- ☐ Sheet A total added up. Sheet B rows each have times or an outcome.
- ☐ Sheets given to the project lead. Date: _____

Source plan: item OF-4 in the project's "work while waiting" list. Measures feed Parts 07 (queue), 12 (reports), 13 (evaluation) and the go-live comparison in Part 14.